

Switzerland: Canton flags



OBWALDEN

The red and white flag was used in Obwalden from the 13th century and it was adopted when the separate canton was formed in 1815. Further to this, a key was added in 1816.



SCHAFFHAUSEN

The emblem has been in use since the 14th century. It depicts a ram (the “sheep” of the town’s name) on a yellow field. The flag’s existence was first recorded as early as 1386.



SOLOTHURN

The coat of arms dates back to 1394 and has colors derived from those of the Confederation. The flag was originally red with a white cross, but was simplified into its current form.



TICINO

The colors of Ticino’s flag may be derived from the French *Tricolore*, or from the main colors of the arms of the united townships.



SANKT GALLEN

The emblems of Sankt Gallen—an ax and a fasces—were adopted in 1803 when the canton was formed under French influence. They are both symbols of republicanism.



SCHWYZ

Schwyz was one of the first three cantons, and the one from which the country takes its name. Its arms existed before the Confederation was formed in 1291.



THURGAU

The flag of Thurgau, adopted in 1803, depicts two gold lions arranged diagonally. They are taken from the coat of arms which dates from medieval times.



URI

The emblem is an auroch’s head (linked to the canton’s name). It dates from the 13th century, but the nose-ring was added later.